

Key Terms

- *Methodology*: is the 'theory of methods.' It refers to the overall theoretical rationale and the principles that define how a research question, set of methods and data are embedded within a perspective.
- *Methods*: are the tools and techniques that you use for gathering and/or analyzing data
- *Data*: is what you gather when you apply a method. Data can come in any shape or form, it can refer to behavior, inner experiences, something material or something symbolic.

Ontology Vs. Epistemology

- Ontology*: is the philosophical study of being a branch of metaphysics. It refers to your view of reality and to what extent it exists 'out there', to be captured through research. Ontology is concerned with what is true or real.
- Epistemology*: is the 'theory of knowledge'. It refers to the principles of what can be known and how you can know it; that is, how you can find out about it.

POSITIVISM

- Philosophical approach based on the belief that only things which can be experienced through the senses can count as true knowledge
- Most important proponent is Auguste Comte (1798-1857)
- Five primary principals
 1. Scientific knowledge should be based on observable reality
 2. Scientific knowledge should be supported by some form of shared reality
 3. Scientific knowledge needs to be based on testable theories
 4. Scientific knowledge is a process with an endpoint which would be a utopian state of perfect society
- Most of what we call “science” or “hard science” is based on these principals

POST-POSITIVISM

- A more flexible version of positivism, practiced (whether consciously or not) by most contemporary scientists.
- Post-positivists believe that a reality exists, but, unlike positivists, they believe reality can be known only imperfectly.
- Post-positivists pursue objectivity by recognizing the possible effects of biases and try to eliminate biases.
- Quantitative and Qualitative methods



CONSTRUCTIVISM

- A general term for philosophical approaches based on the belief that some object or objects are grounded in, or caused, constituted, or controlled by, social or cultural factors rather than natural factors.
- These objects may include but are not limited to emotions, gender, race, sex, homo- and hetero-sexuality, mental illness, technology, quarks, facts, reality, and truth.
- The motivation of constructivist research is in showing that such objects are or were under our control, and therefore they could be, or might have been, otherwise.
- Not just 'x' is socially constructed, but usually 'x' is constructed by 'y' (e.g. capital, patriarchy, white supremacy, etc.)





Feminists - Harding

- Standpoint Theory
- Sandra Harding
 - Argues for the importance of starting from the experiences of those who have been traditionally left out of the mainstream institutional production of knowledge
- “Strong Objectivity”
 - Argues that knowledge that is produced from the point of view of subordinated groups may offer stronger objectivity due to the increased motivation for those groups to understand the views or perspectives of those in positions of power.



Black Feminists

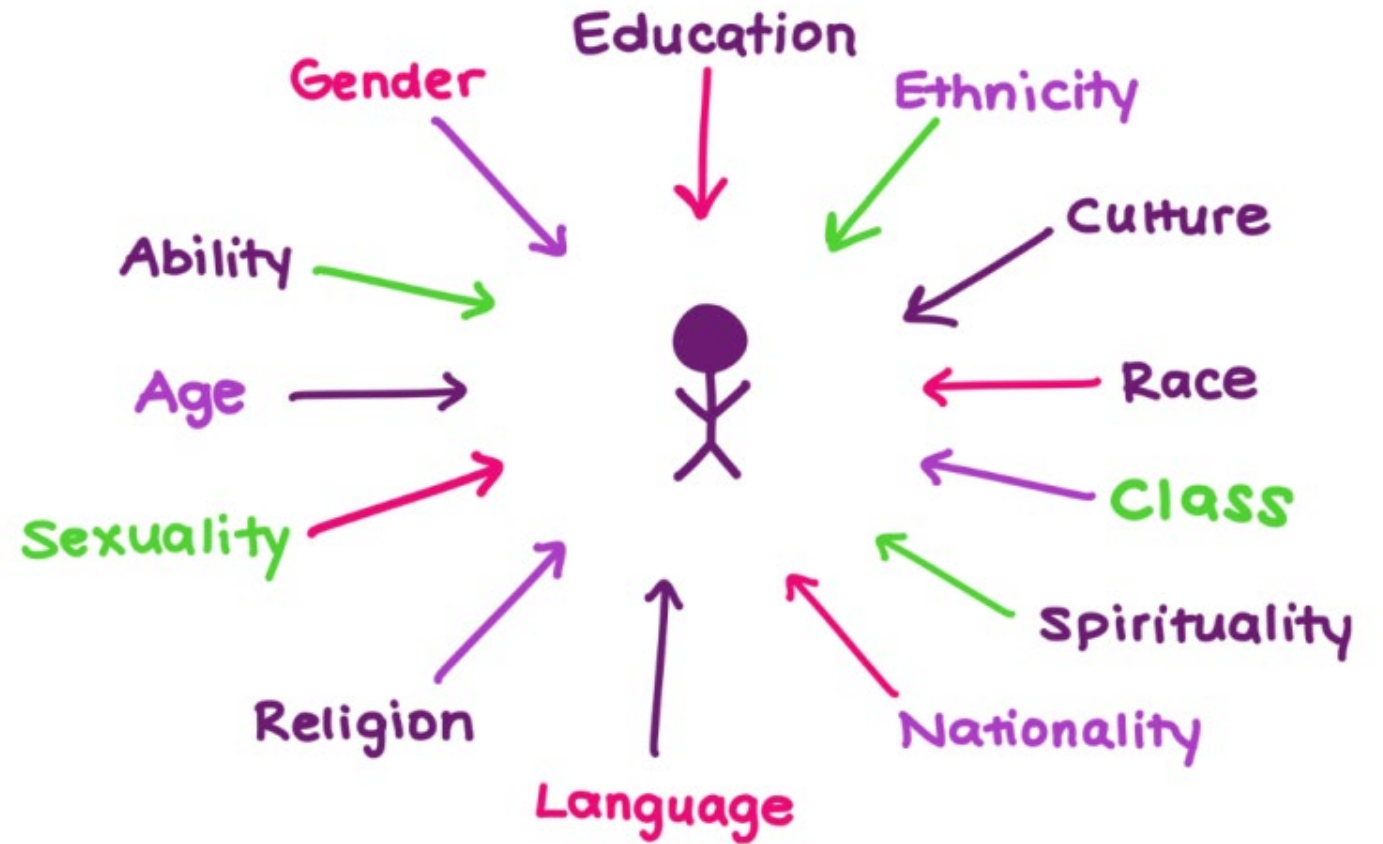
- Black Feminist perspectives
- Emphasizing the importance of a racialized embodiment
- Combahee River Collective (“interlocking systems of oppression” 1977)
- Kimberlee Crenshaw (“intersectionality” 1989 & 1990)
- Patricia Hill Collins (“matrix of oppression” 1992)



Kimberlé Crenshaw



1. Positionalities as the **intersecting** aspects of any person's identity
2. Intersecting forces of privilege and oppression at work in society.



Feminist Empiricism

- Combines the objectives and observations of feminism with more traditional research methods and empirical focus of mainstream science. Feminist empiricism is typically connected to more mainstream notions of positivism.
- Critiques what it perceives to be shortcomings and biases within mainstream research methods.
- Miriam Solomon





Post Modern Feminists

- Post Modern/Post-Structural
- Donna Haraway
- “Situated Knowledges”
 - The notion that all forms of knowledge reflect the particular conditions in which they are produced, and at some level reflect the identities and social locations of knowledge producers.
 - Put otherwise, all knowledge is situated knowledge.
 - Direct challenge to positivist notions of objectivity.
- “God Trick”
 - objectivity understood as impartiality and a "view from above, from nowhere”
 - hides a very specific position (male, white, heterosexual, human) and thus makes this position universal.



Donna Haraway

- Donna Jeanne Haraway (born September 6, 1944)
- Professor emerita in the history of consciousness and feminist studies departments at the University of California, Santa Cruz
- Received her Ph.D. in biology from Yale in 1972 writing a dissertation about the use of metaphor in shaping experiments in experimental biology titled *The Search for Organizing Relations: An Organismic Paradigm in Twentieth-Century Developmental Biology*.



Haraway's Writings

- Critiques of traditional notions of gender, identity, and the body, illustrated through the concept of the "cyborg" as a way to challenge conventional boundaries between humans, animals, and machines.
- Inter-species relations as entangled and co-constitutive
- Possibility of ethical forms of post-humanism
- The role of stories and story telling in creating new political and ethical arrangement



CYBORG MANIFESTO



DONNA HARAWAY

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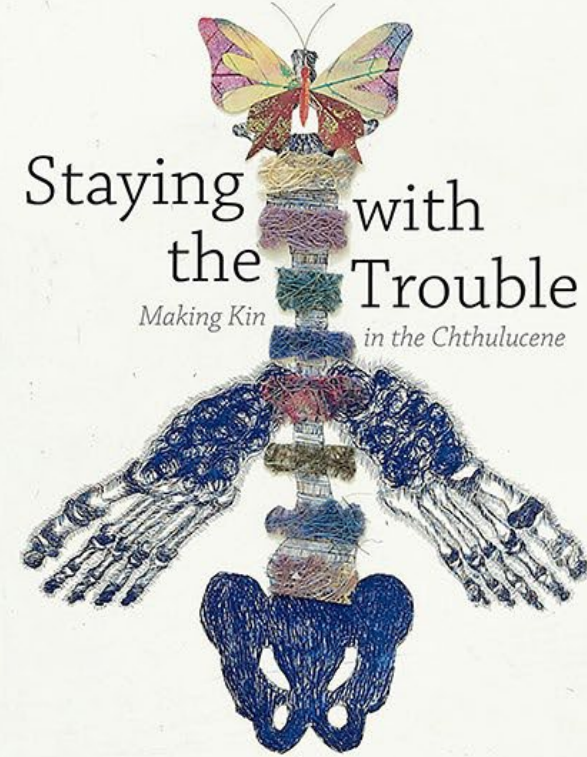
DONNA HARAWAY

THE COMPANION SPECIES MANIFESTO

DOGS, PEOPLE, AND
SIGNIFICANT OTHERNESS

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Staying with the Trouble

Making Kin in the Chthulucene

DONNA J. HARAWAY